

Problem 4. Simte Verbs

Solution:

Since the words in each sentence are repeated in the other sentences in the data, let us find common words and their corresponding meaning. Accordingly, we can tabulate the data with its Simte word, the equivalent meaning in English and the common sentences.

Simte	English	Corresponding sentences	Explanation
lian	big	1 and 2	common word <i>lian</i> means ‘big’ according to the given meanings.
ka	my	1 and 5	common word <i>ka</i> means ‘my’.
puanaahtung	coat	1 and 3	comparing the given data
ahi	Is (sentence completion marker)	1, 5, 7, 8, 9, 12, 14, 19, 21	Most of the sentences contain <i>ahi</i> at the end of the sentences indicating a sense of completion.
kei	I	3, 6, 15, 16	Wherever the word <i>kei</i> appears, the translation is given as ‘I’.
silh	To wear	3	comparing the given data
chi	This	7	comparing the given data
Asang rong	Red	5 and 7	Comparison of sentences 5 and 7
puan	Dress	5	comparing the given data
teng	To wear	6	comparing the given data
Amah	He / she	4, 11, 18, 22	The data in the sentences 4, 11, 18 and 22 indicate that Simte does not distinguish between 3 rd person masculine and feminine genders. Thus <i>amah</i> means ‘he / she’.
Bangtan akhat	pretty	8, 9	we find 2 common words: <i>bangtan akhat</i> . Since, we already know that <i>puan</i> in sentence 9 means ‘dress’, <i>ahi</i> is the sentence completion marker and <i>ka</i> is ‘my’, therefore, <i>bangtan akhat</i> could mean ‘pretty’.
khi	necklace	8, 13	comparing the given data
awh	To wear	13	comparing the given data

na	your	8	comparing the given data
Aeng rong	yellow	12	If <i>asan rong</i> is 'red' then <i>aeng rong</i> in sentence 12 could mean 'yellow'.
kengtohphah	shoes	14	comparing the given data
deih	To like	15	comparing the given data
but	To wear	16	comparing the given data
tau	bangles	17	Since the objects precede just before the verb in this language, <i>tau</i> could mean 'bangles' and hence <i>nang</i> would be 'you'.
nang	you	17	Comparing the given data
samuldial	muffler	20	Comparing the given data
akang	white	19	Comparing the given data
Lalluh khuh	Crown/s	4, 21	there seems no separate marker indicating plural
paat	To wear		Comparing the given data
neo	small		Comparing the given data
Lukhuh	cap		Comparing the given data
maidawh			

Looking at the data, we now have 5 different verbs in Simte used for the English verb 'to wear'.

1. silh	puannah = shirt, puantung = coat.
1. teng	<i>puanten</i> = the traditional wear worn by women, <i>tokatual</i> = trousers / pants.
1. awh	<i>khi</i> = necklace, <i>samuldial</i> = muffler
1. but	<i>kengtohphah</i> = shoes, <i>tau</i> = bangles
1. paat	<i>lalluh khuh</i> = crown, <i>lukhuh</i> <i>maidawh</i> = cap

Thus we can conclude that, in Simte, the verbs indicating 'to wear' are used distinctly according to what one is wearing. Thus *silh* is used for objects that one wears above the waist and *teng* is used for clothing that one wears around / below the waist. Then *awh* is used for objects or clothes that are worn around the neck, *paat* is used for objects worn on the head and *but* for objects worn as accessories or objects worn externally.

So the solutions are as follows:

Q1. Translate:

- 1) He is wearing a big white muffler
amah samuldial lian akang awh
- 2) I like necklaces
kei khi deih
- 3) Your dress is yellow in colour
na puan aeng rong ahi
- 4) She is wearing a red bangle
amah tau asan rong but
- 5) He is wearing this small cap.
amah chi lukhuh maidawh neo paat